Executive analysis (v1)

What We Did

Analyzed Method's MWD (Manufacturing, Wholesale, Distribution) vertical using:

- **1,019 classified accounts** with industry, LTV, tenure, custom screen data
- **Amplitude usage data** (90-day window) for behavior patterns
- **Retention analysis** (52-week) comparing segments
- **1,236 MWD-filtered feature requests** (from 1,646 total)

Key Findings

1. MWD is a Product-Centric Operations Platform

MWD customers use Method as a **transaction-centric operations platform** for physical goods:

Generic CRM	Method MWD
Lead → Contact → Opportunity	Quote → Order → Fulfill → Ship → Invoice
Contact management	**Transaction management**
Sales pipeline	**Demand-to-Cash workflow**
Optional integrations	QuickBooks sync foundational

MWD Workflow: Quote → Sales Order → Pick/Pack → Ship → Invoice → Collect

Evidence: Transaction screens dominate - Invoice: 572K, Estimate: 509K, Sales Order: 311K events (90-day)

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2. Customization Predicts Retention (5x Difference)

Segment	Week 1	Week 52
Customized (1+ screens)	80%	40%
Stock Only	44%	8%

Implication: Target accounts complex enough to customize. Build features that drive customization.

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3. Multi-User Accounts Retain Better (2x Difference)

Segment	Week 1	Week 28
2+ Users	66%	21%
First User Only	34%	9%

Implication: Target businesses with teams (operations, warehouse, sales), not solo operators.

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4. B2B

Key Finding: MWD is overwhelmingly a **B2B platform** (83% of accounts), serving wholesale distributors, manufacturers, and commercial operations.

Metric	B2B	B2C	Insight
Account Count	912 (83%)	184 (17%)	5:1 ratio
Avg Customers	4,795	7,303	B2B serves more business customers
Avg Employees	16.5	19.0	Similar company size
Avg Custom Screens	15.3	15.6	Both customize equally

Strategic Implications:

1. **B2B is the core market** - 83% of MWD accounts are B2B
2. **Portal usage is likely underestimated** - Need Amplitude Guest- screen data to identify B2B portal adopters
3. **Retail classification needs refinement** - All 184 B2C accounts are "Retail" vertical, but many retail accounts may actually serve businesses (B2B2C)

4. **Targeting should prioritize B2B indicators** - Customer count, wholesale/distribution keywords

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5. Top MWD Industries to Target

Rank	Industry	Accounts	Total LTV	Why Target
1 a	**Food & Beverage**	161	$953K	Distribution workflow, Spirits/Coffee/Beer verticals
1 b	**Construction & Building**	97	$900K LTV	Highest avg LTV ($900K),primarily **building materials distributors** (flooring, doors/windows, HVAC equipment suppliers
2	**Healthcare & Medical**	52	$772K	Medical Equipment/Supplies
3	**Consumer Goods**	89	$662K	Wholesale jewelry, apparel, promotional products
4	**Industrial**	87	$757K	Material handling, tools, janitorial distribution
5	**Manufacturing**	113	$251K	Packaging, contract assembly, custom fabrication

Adjacent (high value but different workflow):

- Construction & Building: 97 accounts, $900K LTV - project-based, needs Job Costing

> **Note on Construction & Building**: These accounts are primarily **building materials distributors** (flooring, doors/windows, HVAC equipment suppliers) rather than general contractors. They consider themselves MWD because they wholesale/distribute physical products. However, their workflow is **job-centric (Quote → Job → Progress Invoice) vs. MWD's order-centric workflow (Quote → Order → Ship → Invoice)**, which is why Job Costing is critical for this segment.

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6. Top MWD Sub-Industries by LTV

Sub-Industry	Accounts	Total LTV	Avg LTV
Spirits Distribution	55	$510K	$9.6K
Medical Equipment	17	$371K	$21.8K
Jewelry Wholesale	35	$354K	$10.7K
Flooring Distribution	12	$156K	$14.2K
Industrial Distribution	25	$159K	$7.6K

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7. Top Product Priorities (MWD-Aligned)

Rank	What to Build	Feature Requests	Why
1	**QB Sync Fixes**	718 asks (auto-numbering alone)	Table stakes - core workflow

2	**Job Costing/Projects**	153+84+64 asks	50+ accounts building custom
3	**Inventory/Shipping**	117+78+49 asks	MWD distribution workflow
4	**Customer Portal**	195+159+47 asks	B2B self-service differentiator

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8. Model Accounts (Highest Engagement + LTV)

Account	Industry	LTV	Users	Custom Screens
dewesoft	Technology/Data Acquisition	$182K	74	174
fujimats	Sports/Martial Arts Equipment	$105K	20	135
yoderbilt	Construction/Greenhouses	$94K	24	110
brownsafe	Security/Luxury Safes	$85K	20	182
chapmanco	Food & Beverage/Spirits	$56K	42	204

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connoilsCo1 - $967/mo (2.5 months) - Pricing/Customization

"It doesn't actually do what we were expecting without having to pay exorbitant fees to get close."

Lost because: Base product insufficient, customization too expensive

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Confidence Levels

Finding	Confidence	Basis
Customization drives retention	HIGH	52-week retention data, 2,615 users
Multi-user drives retention	HIGH	28-week retention data, 1,122 users
F&B/Distribution is top target	HIGH	161 accounts, strong LTV
QB Sync is table stakes	HIGH	718 asks for auto-numbering
Portal is differentiator	HIGH	200K+ events, unique B2B positioning

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Limitations

1. **Correlation ≠ Causation**: Customization may be a proxy for commitment, not cause of retention
2. **Survival Bias**: 2+ user accounts may only get users after surviving initial evaluation
3. **No Industry Retention**: Retention not segmented by industry (would need additional analysis)
4. **No Revenue Correlation**: Usage retention, not revenue/expansion retention

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Recommended Next Steps

1. **Fix auto-numbering** - 718 asks, quick win, table stakes
2. **Validate Job Costing MVP** with model accounts (chapmanco, dewesoft)
3. **Review with Engineering** for build complexity estimates
4. **Prioritize Inventory/Shipping** for distribution workflow

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Document Index

#	Document	Purpose

1	This document	High-level summary
2	WHO Decision Matrix	Industry targeting
3	WHAT Decision Matrix	Product priorities
4	Retention Analysis	Detailed retention data
5	MWD Unique Positioning	How MWD differs from CRM
6	Amplitude Custom Apps	Custom screen patterns
7	Industry Workflows	Workflow requirements
8	Roadmap	Prioritized feature roadmap
9	MWD Industries	Sub-industries in MWD
10	MWD Industry classification & definition	Sub industry definition
11	Net new apps	Opportunities for new stock apps

Analysis based on 1,019 classified accounts, Amplitude data (90-day), retention analysis (52-week), and 1,236 MWD-filtered feature requests.